IELTS ACADEMIC · RESTRICTED STAFF MATERIAL

IELTS Academic Set 26

PRIVATE STAFF answer key and Listening transcript

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Answer keys and Listening transcripts are restricted to staff.

Listening

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
1	certificate	
2	three	3
3	Wednesday	
4	10:40	ten forty
5	passport	
6	courier	courier return
7	solicitor	
8	date	
9	application letter	printed letter
10	reference number	
11	D	
12	E	
13	A	
14	C	
15	B	
16	B	
17	A	
18	B	
19	C	

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Question	Answer	Accepted variants
20	A	
21	B	
22	D	
23	F	
24	A	
25	G	
26	rundown	
27	news bulletin	bulletin
28	two minutes	2 minutes
29	red	
30	pronunciations	
31	nitrogen oxides	NOx
32	ammonia	
33	nitric acid	
34	ammonium nitrate	
35	low temperatures	
36	filter samples	samples
37	C	
38	A	
39	B	
40	C	

Listening transcript

Part 1 - Everyday social dialogue: arranging certified copies in Wellington, New Zealand

Hana Rangi	Good morning, Harbour Document Centre. Hana speaking. We arrange witnessed signatures and certified copies by appointment. How can I help?
Tessa Whitlock	Hello. I need certified copies for an overseas application. I began the online booking, but I was not sure which service to choose or what identification to bring.
Hana Rangi	I can complete the booking with you. First, which original document needs to be copied? We handle certificates, qualifications and several other records, but the original must be available for comparison.
Tessa Whitlock	It is my birth certificate. I also have a university transcript, although the organisation has asked for an ordinary scan of that, so it does not need certification.

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Hana Rangi	Fine. How many certified copies of the birth certificate are required? The booking page sometimes carries over the number from a previous enquiry.
Tessa Whitlock	I first selected two, then checked the application letter again. It asks for three copies, so please put three on the appointment form.
Hana Rangi	We have Tuesday afternoon at twenty past three, Wednesday morning at ten forty, or Friday just after midday. The Wednesday slot allows extra time if all three copies need separate marks.
Tessa Whitlock	Wednesday at ten forty would be best. Friday was my first thought, but I need to post the application before then.
Hana Rangi	For identity, bring a current photo document. A driving licence is accepted, but you mentioned in your form that its address is old. Your passport will be simpler because it is current.
Tessa Whitlock	Then I will bring my passport, along with the original certificate. I will leave the old driving licence at home so there is no confusion.
Hana Rangi	Would you like to collect the copies, or should we return them? Standard post is inexpensive, while our courier return includes tracking and requires a signature.
Tessa Whitlock	Please use the courier. I considered collecting them, but I will be outside Wellington for work the next day and tracking would be reassuring.
Hana Rangi	That is noted. A solicitor is available at that appointment. A Justice of the Peace also certifies copies in many situations, but none is rostered here on Wednesday morning.
Tessa Whitlock	A solicitor is acceptable for this application. Does each copy simply receive a signature, or is anything else required?
Hana Rangi	The certifier compares each copy with the original and adds the required statement. Beside the signature, the date must be written clearly. Please do not write on the copies yourself before the appointment.
Tessa Whitlock	Understood. Apart from the originals and my passport, should I bring proof of what the receiving organisation wants?
Hana Rangi	Yes, bring the application letter. It lets the solicitor check whether the receiving organisation has specified particular wording. A screenshot on your phone is not necessary if you have the letter.
Tessa Whitlock	I have the printed letter, so I will add it to the folder. How do I recognise the return parcel if a courier message arrives while I am travelling?
Hana Rangi	Your confirmation email will contain a reference number. The same reference number appears on the courier label and in the tracking message. It is more reliable than searching by your surname.
Tessa Whitlock	Perfect. So the booking is Wednesday at ten forty for three certified copies of my birth certificate, with courier return.
Hana Rangi	Correct. Bring the original birth certificate, your passport and the application letter. We will email the reference number within a few minutes. Please arrive five minutes early, but there is no need to come before the centre opens.

Part 2 - Everyday social monologue: beginner induction at a river paddling centre near Cork, Ireland

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Maeve Donnelly	Welcome to the Lee Valley paddling centre. I am Maeve, and I will lead today's beginner session. Before we enter the water, I will explain the equipment and the changing arrangements.
Maeve Donnelly	Buoyancy aids are arranged by size near the door, but please do not pick one up immediately. I have the booking list and will call surnames in order. Wait until you hear yours before taking an aid; we need to record the size issued.
Maeve Donnelly	Whistles arrive clipped to the aids, although they are logged separately. At the end, do not put yours into the general equipment crate. Unclip it and hand it back separately; reception staff count them before the next group.
Maeve Donnelly	Each pair has a spare paddle. Before you carry it down the path, show it to the assistant at the riverside gate. She will check the blade number against your boat; the check is not done at the equipment rack.
Maeve Donnelly	We also lend dry bags for small essentials. They remain behind the desk while I give this safety talk, so do not take one from the bench. When the talk ends, collect the bag from reception and write its number on your locker slip.
Maeve Donnelly	The throw line is already secured beside the bank assistant's position. Leave it where it is when you move the boats; a trained staff member will remove it if needed. Beginners should not carry it to the water or practise with it today.
Maeve Donnelly	Now, changing rooms. The upstairs room looks larger, but building work has closed it this week. Use the ground-floor changing room beside reception. The outdoor shelter is for wet equipment after the session, not for changing clothes.
Maeve Donnelly	Once changed, place bags in the lockers and meet beside the equipment rack. We launch in a fixed order. The instructor enters first and waits downstream. Paddlers then launch one at a time. The bank assistant goes last after checking that nothing has been left behind.
Maeve Donnelly	You may hear three possible signals. One short whistle means look towards the instructor and wait for a hand signal. Two short blasts mean gather near the bank. A continuous blast means leave the water at the nearest safe landing point. Today we will practise the two-blast signal before travelling upstream.
Maeve Donnelly	People often ask whether light rain cancels a session. Usually it does not. We check river level, wind and official weather information together. If conditions become unsafe, the centre manager - not an individual participant - makes the cancellation decision and sends a text to the booking contact.
Maeve Donnelly	If you receive no text, check in at reception. A warning triggers a fresh risk assessment. We may shorten the route or keep the group on the sheltered practice channel.
Maeve Donnelly	At the water's edge, keep the boat parallel to the bank while the assistant steadies it. Sit down before placing both feet inside. Do not push off until the instructor calls your name. That prevents two beginners from entering the narrow channel together.
Maeve Donnelly	During the trip, stay between the lead instructor and the bank assistant. If you lose sight of the person ahead, stop in calm water rather than racing to catch up. Raise your paddle horizontally only if you need help; it is not our signal for an ordinary rest.
Maeve Donnelly	When we return, carry the boats to the marked stands. Leave wet buoyancy aids on the ventilated rail, not in your locker. Rinse the paddles at the hose, but report any damage before you clean it, so staff can see the problem clearly.

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Maeve Donnelly	Finally, remember the order: change downstairs, fit and check equipment, meet at the rack, then launch one at a time behind the instructor. We will now divide into pairs and practise fitting the buoyancy aids before walking to the river.

Part 3 - Educational discussion: trainee producers revise a live-radio rundown in Manchester

Amira Voss	We need to repair the running order for tomorrow’s twenty-eight-minute training programme. Since Professor Lane cancelled, I have moved the recorded market interview into his slot, but the timings still do not close.
Ethan Sloane	Let us work in transmission order. The opening headlines currently take ninety seconds because each story has background detail. They should orient listeners, not repeat the later packages.
Amira Voss	So for the opening headlines, we shorten the summary and keep only one sentence per story. I had considered dropping the local arts item entirely, but its full report appears later and still needs a headline.
Ethan Sloane	Next is the recorded market interview. The raw interview lasts four minutes forty. The strongest answer begins after a long introduction, so trim the insert to two minutes and start with the vendor explaining the price change.
Amira Voss	Agreed. I will keep the natural breath before her answer, but remove the presenter’s repeated question. That should sound edited rather than rushed.
Ethan Sloane	The traffic bulletin is scheduled after the culture review, yet the road closure begins during our broadcast. Move that bulletin earlier, immediately after the opening headlines, so the information reaches commuters in time.
Amira Voss	Earlier makes sense. Now the empty studio-guest slot: I suggested extending the culture review, but we do not have enough checked material for another three minutes.
Ethan Sloane	Use selected listener messages instead. We already have permission to broadcast five, and the presenter can read three contrasting responses. That replaces the cancelled guest without pretending we have a new interview.
Amira Voss	For the closing trail, the recorded version advertises next week’s guest by name. Since the booking is not confirmed, we should replace the name with the programme topic rather than delete the whole trail.
Ethan Sloane	Yes, revise the wording so it promises a discussion about neighbourhood transport, not a particular speaker. That is our fifth rundown change.
Amira Voss	I am updating my paper copy as we talk. Should I send you a photograph when it is finished?
Ethan Sloane	Better to put every change in the shared rundown. A photograph cannot show whether the presenter, studio manager and news desk are looking at the same version.
Amira Voss	Right. We should backtime from the fixed news bulletin at half past the hour. Its start cannot move, so our programme must finish cleanly before that feed opens.
Ethan Sloane	Exactly. With the market insert limited to two minutes, the revised total becomes twenty-seven minutes forty. That leaves twenty seconds for the continuity cue and a safe handover.
Amira Voss	The presenter needs to recognise that cue instantly. Last week we wrote it in black like the ordinary notes.

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Ethan Sloane	This time put the continuity cue in red. Do not colour the whole final line; only the words that tell the presenter to stop and hand to news.
Amira Voss	I will also mark the music fades. The opening bed ends under the first headline, and the closing bed begins only after the listener messages.
Ethan Sloane	Good. Before rehearsal, we need a final check of pronunciations. The street name in the traffic item and the artist’s surname in the culture review are both easy to misread.
Amira Voss	I can confirm them with the contributors and add phonetic notes. What about the presenter links between items? Some still refer to Professor Lane.
Ethan Sloane	Rewrite those links after the order is locked. Otherwise you may polish wording that moves again. The listener-message introduction should explain that the guest cancelled, but it does not need to describe why.
Ethan Sloane	Rehearse the exact two-minute insert that will be transmitted. If the edit feels abrupt, we fix it now. Using a different rehearsal file creates false confidence about the timing.
Amira Voss	Then I will export the final insert, label it clearly and link it from the shared rundown. I will remove the older draft from the playout list, though I will keep it in the project archive.
Ethan Sloane	I will move the traffic bulletin and prepare the three listener messages. Once your timings are entered, we can perform a backtime check from the news bulletin and then read every transition aloud.
Amira Voss	So our final plan is: shortened headlines, traffic earlier, a two-minute market insert, listener messages in the guest slot, and a topic-only closing trail. All changes go in the shared rundown.
Ethan Sloane	And the continuity cue is red, with pronunciations checked before rehearsal. That should make the programme both accurate and calm under live conditions.

Part 4 - Academic monologue: urban nitrate aerosols at a Toronto university

Lecturer	Today we will examine nitrate in fine urban particles. Nitrate is not usually emitted as a finished particle in the way that road dust is. It forms through atmospheric reactions, so we need to follow the gases, the chemistry and the conditions that shift material between gas and particle phases.
Lecturer	The first precursor is nitrogen oxides, often written as NOx. In cities, important sources include vehicles and combustion. These gases undergo oxidation in the atmosphere. The chemistry differs between day and night, but both pathways can ultimately produce nitric acid.
Lecturer	The second important gas is ammonia. Agricultural activity is a major source over broad regions, although urban sources also exist. Air masses do not respect municipal boundaries, so ammonia formed outside a city can influence particulate nitrate measured within it.
Lecturer	Now consider the simplified sequence. Nitrogen oxides are oxidised to nitric acid. Nitric acid then reacts with ammonia. One important product is ammonium nitrate, which can enter the fine-particle fraction. This diagram is a teaching simplification: real air contains competing compounds and surfaces.

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Lecturer	Whether ammonium nitrate remains in particles depends strongly on temperature. Low temperatures generally favour the particle phase, while warmer conditions encourage some material to return to gases. Relative humidity and the presence of other ions also matter, so temperature alone does not predict every observation. Later, laboratories analyse filter samples for those ions.
Lecturer	This helps explain why nitrate often shows a seasonal pattern. A cold winter atmosphere can support particulate nitrate, and a winter inversion may trap pollutants close to the ground. In summer, stronger mixing can dilute local concentrations and greater heat can shift volatile material away from particles.
Lecturer	Notice that the inversion is a meteorological condition, not a chemical ingredient. It limits vertical mixing. If precursor gases and newly formed particles remain in a shallow layer, concentrations near monitoring sites can rise even when emissions have not increased by the same proportion.
Lecturer	How do researchers measure this material? A filter sampler draws a known volume of air through a filter. Laboratories can analyse filter samples for ions such as nitrate and ammonium. The method supplies chemical composition, not merely the total mass of fine particles.
Lecturer	Total particle mass remains valuable, but it cannot by itself identify which chemical components produced a peak. Two days may have similar fine-particle mass while one contains more nitrate and the other more organic material or sulfate. Composition measurements therefore change the scientific interpretation.
Lecturer	Filters also introduce uncertainty. Ammonium nitrate is semi-volatile. Material collected on a filter can partly evaporate during sampling, transport or storage, especially if temperature changes. A low laboratory result may therefore reflect loss from the filter rather than low nitrate in the original air.
Lecturer	The opposite problem can occur when gases are retained by the sampling system and later counted as particles. Researchers use blanks, careful handling and comparison instruments to estimate these artefacts. No single correction works perfectly under all atmospheric conditions.
Lecturer	Continuous instruments provide finer time resolution than a twenty-four-hour filter. They can reveal a morning rise or a rapid response to changing weather. However, those instruments also require calibration and may infer composition indirectly. High time resolution does not automatically mean lower uncertainty.
Lecturer	For that reason, a strong study combines methods. Filter analysis gives detailed chemical evidence; continuous instruments show short-term change; meteorological observations help explain mixing and temperature. Agreement among them is more persuasive than a single dramatic reading.
Lecturer	Researchers also compare sites. A roadside station reflects nearby traffic more strongly, while an urban-background station samples a broader mixture. Yet a higher nitrate value beside a road does not prove that all nitrate was emitted there, because secondary formation can occur during transport.
Lecturer	Policy interpretation must separate precursor control from particle measurement. Reducing nitrogen oxides can alter nitric-acid production, while reducing ammonia changes neutralisation. The response may be nonlinear because other atmospheric compounds compete for ammonia and because weather varies between years.

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Lecturer	When comparing winters, scientists therefore avoid attributing every decline to one regulation. They examine emissions, temperature, humidity, inversion frequency and the performance of the instruments. A colder year could increase the particle fraction even if precursor emissions fell.
Lecturer	The central lesson is methodological. Nitrate is produced through linked chemical steps, distributed by moving air and observed through imperfect instruments. The best explanation joins the precursor record, the meteorology and more than one measurement method rather than relying on total particle mass alone. It should also report uncertainty openly, distinguish correlation from mechanism, and test whether the same interpretation survives at different sites and times. That caution matters whenever a chemically dynamic pollutant is represented by a single daily number.

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Reading

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
1	feed tank	tank
2	heat exchanger	
3	cooling jacket	jacket
4	scraper	
5	ice slurry	slurry
6	column	
7	dissolved solids	solids
8	freezing point	
9	crystal growth	growth
10	liquor	
11	wash water	water
12	ice melt	
13	concentrate outlet	outlet
14	B	
15	A	
16	C	
17	A	
18	D	
19	B	
20	C	
21	C	
22	A	
23	B	
24	D	
25	A	
26	D	
27	YES	
28	NO	

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Question	Answer	Accepted variants
29	NO	
30	YES	
31	NO	
32	NOT GIVEN	
33	YES	
34	C	
35	E	
36	F	
37	D	
38	G	
39	A	
40	H	

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